OVL Phase 1
Area 2, Area 4, Swale and Bell Mouth excavations, Area 2, 3, 4 and Swale Evaluation, Geotechnical Investigation Works
South Marston
Swindon
Wiltshire

Written scheme of investigation for archaeological excavation

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1 Introduction

1.1 *Project background*

1.1.1 This Written Scheme of Investigation (or WSI) for an archaeological excavation on the site OVL (Old Vicarage Lane) Phase I, South Marston, Swindon, Wiltshire has been commissioned from MOLA by Orion Heritage on behalf of the client Taylor Wimpey.

1.1.2 The site is located to the immediate east of Swindon, bounded by the A420 to the south, A419 to the west and the whole development area is some 165ha (Fig 1).

1.1.3 Phase I excavation is principally located within Area 2 and Area 4, with additional proposed swale and bell mouth excavations, as illustrated on the Proposed Excavation Area Drawings (Fig 2). Additionally, 11 evaluation trenches will be excavated in Area 3 to the NE of Area 2 and NW of Area 4 (Fig 7 and 8). On the east side of OVL there are two proposed excavation areas for bell mouths associated with access roads (Fig 2 and 6). Additional evaluation trenches are also proposed in Area 2 and 4, as well as to the east of the Swale excavation in order to confirm the presence/absence of archaeological remains in these areas (Fig 2, 9, 10 and 11).

1.1.4 MOLA will also monitor ground investigation works due to take place in/around areas of archaeological interest to ensure any archaeology present is either recorded or avoided by these works (Fig 12 and 13).

1.1.5 The centre of Area 2 is at National Grid reference 41908 18732 and the centre of Area 4 is National Grid reference 41947 187361. The site is currently occupied by mixed use agricultural fields. Current ground level across the site lies at c 92-104m OD.

1.1.6 Archaeological investigation of Primary Street (MOLA 2024), the main access road across the site, is ongoing and will intersect with the excavation of Area 4 and the Swale (Fig 2).

1.1.7 The site is being developed to create a sustainable urban extension to the east of Swindon and north of the A420 of up to 2,380 dwellings. The Urban extension will also include mixed use local centres. Areas including retail up to 1,500 sq. meters, services, restaurants, pubs and takeaways, business uses up to 1,000 sq. meters, community uses, sheltered and/or care accommodation, two primary schools. There will also be green infrastructure including formal and informal open space, landscape, biodiversity and amenity space. Provision will be made for play space (including NEAPS/LEAPS/MUGAS) changing and sports facilities and ancillary retail uses. The development also includes sustainable drainage systems, highways, cycle and pedestrian routes, car parking, infrastructure (including utilities). Engineering works include ground remodelling, demolition, site reclamations and removal of structures, the formation of new accesses from the A420, Old Vicarage Lane and Thornhill Road.

1.1.8 Swindon Borough Council are advised on archaeological matters by Wiltshire Council Archaeological Service. The development received outline planning permission on 11th August 2021 and included two conditions relating to archaeology: Condition No 38 and 39.

1.1.9 Condition 38. Archaeology – Written Scheme of Investigation:

> *Prior to the commencement of development in each sub-phase a detailed Written Scheme of Investigation for all of the archaeological*

zones identified within the that sub-phase, in figures 15 and 16 of the Outline Archaeological Mitigation Strategy (V6 31st October 2017) and areas of highway infrastructure within sub-phase areas shown in Figure 17, shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority to enable mitigation by archaeological excavation, trial trenching and monitoring. The development shall be carried out in accordance with the approved Written Scheme of Investigation.

1.1.10 Condition 39 Archaeology Management Plan

Prior to the commencement of development in each sub-phase, a detailed management plan for that sub-phase shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority to ensure the preservation in situ of areas of archaeological importance as indicated in Figure 17 of the outline Archaeological Mitigation Strategy (31st October 2017) No development shall take place except in accordance with the approved details.

Details of the consented development are available here.

1.1.11 The potential archaeological interest on the site is multi-period and include:

- Bronze Age enclosures
- Iron Age enclosures, trackway and pits
- Late Iron Age to Roman settlement
- A possible Roman metalled surface
- Roman field systems
- Medieval field systems

1.1.12 An archaeological excavation as defined by the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists (CIfA) is 'Archaeological excavation involves a programme of intrusive fieldwork with defined research objectives which examines, records and interprets archaeological deposits, features and structures and, as appropriate, retrieves artefacts, ecofacts and other remains within a specified area or site on land, in an inter-tidal zone or under water' (CIfA, 2023a).[1]

1.1.13 The CIfA standard for archaeological excavation states 'An archaeological excavation will examine and record the archaeological resource within a specified area using methods that are described in a project design1 that is fit for purpose. The work undertaken will be carried out by suitably competent persons in accordance with that project design and the CIfA Code of conduct and give due regard to the guidance for archaeological excavation. All archaeological excavations will result in a report, published accounts where appropriate, and a stable, ordered, accessible archive' (CIfA 2023a and b).

1.1.14 A site-wide over-arching archaeological written scheme of investigation has previously been prepared which sets out specific areas for archaeological excavation (Orion 2022). This WSI sets outs the methodology for the archaeological excavation of Area 2, including an access road, Area 4, a proposed additional Swale excavation, two evaluation trenches in Area 3, and two bell mouth excavations east of OVL.

1.1.15 Area 1/2: An area proposed for housing and contains the remains of a late Iron Age and Roman 'ladder' settlement. The access road to the proposed housing in Area 1 crosses north-south from the development's primary street (the line of the main access road will have been fully excavated as part of the enabling works) (Fig 2). Area 1 contains the majority of the Roman settlement south of Manor Farm. It is planned that the duration of the Area 2 excavation

will be 9 weeks following stripping completion. Five additional 40m long by 1.8m wide trenches have also been proposed within the scope of Area 2 to better ascertain the presence/absence of archaeological remains. Should these trenches show an absence of archaeological remains within areas of the site, there is potential for a change in the scope of works required for the overall strip.

1.1.16 Area 4: An area to the east of Area 2. The haul road runs through this area following the same route as the primary street (Fig 2). This phase of excavation will be on both sides of the 21m wide corridor centred on the line of the primary street. Included within this area of excavation will be the proposed additional swale excavation to the SW of Area 5 (Fig 5). It is planned that the duration of the Area 4 excavation will be 6 weeks following stripping completion. Three additional 40m long by 1.8m wide trenches (Fig 10) have also been proposed within the scope of Area 4 to better ascertain the presence/absence of archaeological remains. Should these trenches show an absence of archaeological remains within areas of the site, there is potential for a change in the scope of works required for the overall strip.

1.1.17 Swale excavation: The proposed additional Swale excavation is located in the strip of land to east of Area 4 and to the southwest of Area 5 (Fig 2). It is planned that duration of the Swale excavation will be 3 weeks. One additional 40m long by 1.8m wide trench has also been proposed along the south-eastern arm of the Swale to ascertain the presence/absence of archaeological remains. Should this trench show presence/absence of archaeological remains within this area of the site, there is potential for a change in the scope of works required for the overall strip.

1.1.18 Area 3: Eleven evaluation trenches measuring 40m x 1.8m will be excavated to the NE of Area 2 and the NW of Area 4, located across four fields (Fig 2, 8 and 9).

1.1.19 Bell mouths: Two small excavation areas located east of OVL are proposed to allow access routes to be constructed into the eastern portion of the development (Fig 2 and 6). It is anticipated that the duration of these works will be 2 weeks.

1.1.20 Ground Investigations: Several trial pits and boreholes are proposed across the South Marston and Rowborough development areas (Fig 12 and 13). Where these are located in archaeologically sensitive areas an archaeologist will monitor the works, recording any archaeology identified or, if necessary, moving the location of the works.

1.1.21 The results of the excavation will be set out in a preliminary report to be issued within 12 weeks of completing the fieldwork.

1.1.22 This document sets out the methodologies which will be followed during the excavation and during the post-excavation analysis and reporting stages. These will follow the Standards and Code of Practice laid down by the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists, Wiltshire Council and Historic England where appropriate.

1.1.23 Other relevant documents include:

- Cotswold Archaeology, 2015, *Land at South Marston and Rowborough, Swindon, Wiltshire: Archaeological Evaluation*

  This report sets out the results of the archaeological evaluation carried out in April and May 2015 to the west and east of Manor Farm.

- Foundations Archaeology, 2014, *Manor Gardens, South Marston, Borough of Swindon, Wiltshire: Archaeological Evaluation: Phase 1*

This report sets out the results of the archaeological evaluation on the western side of Manor Farm.

- GHPC Group Ltd, 2024, *Client's Pre-Construction Information - South Marston Archaeology Excavation Works, Woodlands - NEV Swindon*

  This document provides relevant information about the archaeology excavation works and identifies key hazards and perceived risks relating to Health & Safety.

- Orion, 2022, *Land at South Marston and Rowborough, North of the A420, Eastern Villages Swindon, Site-Wide Over-Arching Archaeological Written Scheme of Investigation*

  This document presents a site-wide over-arching Written Scheme of Investigation (WSI) for undertaking an archaeological programme of works for Land North of the A420 at South Marston and Rowborough required under condition 38 of the outline planning consent.

- Stratascan, 2014 *Geophysical Survey Report, South Marston, Wiltshire*

  This report sets out the results of the geophysical survey carried out on the site in 2014.

- Stratascan, 2017, *Land at South Marston, Swindon Eastern Village*

  This geophysical survey report sets out the results of the geophysical survey carried out on the site in 2017.

1.2 *Planning and legislative framework*

1.2.1 This section outlines the relevant National and Local Planning policy that guides the Historic Environment and archaeology.

National Planning Policy Framework

1.2.2 The National Planning Policy Framework (last updated in 2023) outlines the planning policy framework, the section relevant to the protection of the historic environment is section 16.

Archaeology and Planning in Wiltshire

1.2.3 The Wiltshire Core Strategy adopted 2015 states the following regarding the Historic Environment and Archaeology:

Core Policy 58 aims to ensure that Wiltshire's important monuments, sites and landscapes and areas of historic and built heritage significance are protected and enhanced in order that they continue to make an important contribution to Wiltshire's environment and quality of life. Heritage assets include:

- listed buildings
- conservation areas
- scheduled ancient monuments
- registered parks and gardens
- registered battlefields
- world heritage sites
- non-designated heritage assets such as buildings and archaeological sites of regional and local interest.

Within the context of the specific characteristics of Wiltshire, development will be required to be sensitive to all heritage assets including:

• the individual and distinctive character and appearance of Wiltshire's historic market towns and villages
• archaeological monuments and landscapes
• the Stonehenge and Avebury World Heritage Site
• historic buildings and structures related to the textile industry
• historic rural structures including threshing barns, granaries, malt houses, dovecotes and stables
• ecclesiastical sites including churches, chapels and monuments
• the historic Great Western Railway and associated structures
• the historic waterways and associated structures including canals and river courses
• heritage assets associated with the military
• the sensitive re-use of redundant and under-used historic buildings and areas which are consistent with their conservation especially in relation to the viable reuse of heritage assets at risk
• opportunities to enhance Wiltshire's historic public realm by ensuring that all development, including transport and infrastructure work, is sensitive to the historic environment.

1.3 *Geology and Topography*

1.3.1 British Geological Mapping indicates that the excavation area is partially underlain by the Red Down Sand Member which consists of fine to medium grained reddish brown to yellow sands and sandstone. This deposit is of late Jurassic age and is contemporary with the undifferentiated Ampthill Clay and Kimmeridge Clay formations which is the bedrock deposit mapped in the eastern and western areas of the excavation area. These are mudstone deposits are stiff clay of brown and grey colour. There are no superficial deposits mapped within the excavation area.

1.3.2 The current topography ranges between 92m aOD in the east and 104m aOD in the west.

1.3.3 Several earthworks are visible in fields associated with these works, in particular around Area 4 and the Swale. These may be 'Winterbournes' manipulating water movement through the fields, however it is unclear if all of the earthworks relate to this use. Upstanding ridge and furrow has been observed in the area of the southern Bell Mouth excavation.

1.4 *Archaeological background*

1.4.1 The *Site-Wide Overarching WSI* (Orion 2022), and the various archaeological evaluation reports and geophysical reports set out the results of the archaeological field evaluation which have been carried out on the site to date.

1.4.2 The reports should be read for the results of these investigations, the relevant information to Area 2 and Area 4 and the area of the proposed Swale excavation is summarised below:

1.4.3 The geophysical survey recorded an extensive area of settlement remains to the south and south-east of Manor Farm. The geophysical survey recorded a probable 'ladder' settlement in the field on the western side of Manor Farm. The Foundations Archaeology trenching established that this was late Iron Age in date with indications of some Roman activity toward the eastern of the field adjacent to Manor Farm. The evaluation established that the settlement is slightly more extensive than the geophysical survey indicated.

1.4.4 The Foundations Archaeology evaluation targeted the proposed access road that will run through the settlement and the first phase of the Cotswold

Archaeology trenching targeted the eastern area of this complex of anomalies. The trenching established that the geophysical survey results were correct and reliable. Although hand excavation of features during the Foundations Archaeology work was hampered by a high water-table, the trenching demonstrated that the settlement that had Late Iron Age origins and continued into the early 2nd century AD. The eastern edge of the settlement as identified in the geophysical survey, has been established to be real as Trenches 16-18 revealed Roman features on slightly elevated ground above the wetter slightly lower land to east where Trenches 22, 31 & 32 failed to reveal Roman features, presumably to avoid the flooding to which the area to the east may have been prone. The western extent of the settlement within the Proposed Development site as identified in the geophysical survey have been confirmed by the Foundations Archaeology trenching as Trenches 1 & 2 revealed few archaeological features.

1.5 *MOLA team and other responsibilities*

In the document below the following terms should be understood:

1.5.1 *MOLA (Museum of London Archaeology)* is a company limited by guarantee registered in England and Wales with company registration number 07751831 and charity registration number 1143574. Registered office: Mortimer Wheeler House, 46 Eagle Wharf Road, London N1 7ED.

1.5.2 *Project Manager* - MOLA office based manager who is the client's principal point of contact and who has overall responsibility for the project budget and delivery.

1.5.3 *Site Supervisor* - MOLA site based manager who is responsible for the direction of the field team. Site supervisors on larger sites will tend to be 'Project Officers' in grade, whilst on other sites they may be 'Senior Archaeologists' or 'Senior Project Supervisors'. On some sites there may be both a Project Officer and/or one or more 'Senior Archaeologists' or 'Senior Project Supervisors'.

1.5.4 *Archaeologists* - MOLA excavation staff responsible on site for archaeological excavation.

1.5.5 *Field Manager* - MOLA office based manager responsible for allocation of staff and supply of equipment and resources.

1.5.6 *Health and Safety Compliance Manager* – The MOLA manager with sole responsibility for site inspections, reporting and issuing of recommendations for the Site Supervisor and Project Manager to implement. Reports directly to MOLA CEO

1.5.7 *Principal Contractor* - appointed directly by the Client with overall responsibility for site H&S under CDM regulations.

1.5.8 *Attendance Contractor* - the contractor responsible for providing such attendances to MOLA as are deemed necessary to carry out their archaeological work. These might for instance include but not be restricted to shoring, lighting, facilities, fencing, additional labour, spoil removal, etc The Attendance Contractor may be the same as the Principal Contractor, or it may be subcontracted to the Principal Contractor or it may sub-contracted to MOLA.

1.5.9 *Sub-contractor* – where this term is used in this document it refers to any contractor employed directly by MOLA during the course of its work on the site.

2 Objectives of the excavation

2.1 *Overarching Aims and Objectives*

2.1.1 The principal aim of the archaeological programme of works will be to determine the character, extent, date, integrity, state of preservation and quality of any archaeological remains present; therefore, ensuring their preservation by record.

2.1.2 To address the main aim, the general objectives are to:

- Ensure the recording of archaeological assets discovered during the archaeological works;
- Ensure that any below-ground archaeological deposits exposed are promptly identified; and
- Ensure the recording of archaeological remains through full excavation, to place this record in its local context and to make this record available.
- To examine any available evidence for economic activity and environmental conditions for all archaeological periods.
- To generate an archive which will allow future research of the evidence to be undertaken if appropriate.
- To disseminate the results of the work in a format and manner proportionate to the significance of the findings.

2.2 *Site specific objectives and research aims*

2.2.1 The excavation and research is undertaken within priorities established in the South West Archaeological Research Framework

2.2.2 The following research objectives have been compiled after consultation with appropriate experts, and in particular in consideration of the results of previous archaeological investigations both on the site and on other adjacent sites across the area.

2.2.3 The site covers a substantive area, which has been shown to contain a variety of archaeological remains from numerous periods.

2.2.4 Therefore, by virtue of its scale and the known resources, archaeological investigation of the site has the potential to contribute to key over-arching research themes and research aims set out in SWARF for the wider region. Six key strategic themes have been identified as relevant with respect to the fieldwork. These have guided the specific research aims for the work on site:

Theme A: Settlement Sites and Landscapes – Urban, Rural, Maritime and Prehistoric

- Research Aim 10: Address our current lack of understanding of key transitional periods.
- Research Aim 29: Improve understanding of non-villa Roman rural settlement.
- Research Aim 29c: Use of geographical approaches to the identification and study of differing settlement densities and types across the region

Theme B: Artefacts and the Built Environment – Technologies, Resources, Links

to Trade

- Research Aim 14: Widen our understanding of Later Bronze Age and Iron Age material culture.

Theme C: Environment and Dating – landscape change and methodologies

- Research Aim 16e: A better definition of key transitional phases
- Research Aim 16f: Scientific dating for the Iron Age.
- Research Aim 16h: Scientific dating in development control projects.
- Research Aim 17: Improve the quality and quantity of environmental data and our understanding of what it represents
- Research Aim 18e: Analysis of soils.
- Research Aim 19: Improve our understanding of wild and domestic animals in the past
- Research Aim 21a: Development of field systems and intensification of agriculture in the Bronze and Iron Ages
- Research Aim 26: Post-Roman to Early Medieval landscape changes.
- Research Aim 27: Origin of free-threshing wheat (AD 350–1000).

Theme D: Social Identity and Change – Transition, Identity, Territories, Religion, Conflict and Death

- Research Aim 49a: Improve knowledge of Neolithic and Early Bronze Age social life.
- Research Aim 58: Widen our understanding of Roman burial traditions

Theme E: Economies and Subsistence – Trade, Agriculture, Transport and Communication

- Research Aim 39: Understand better the relationships of Neolithic and Bronze Age people to plants.
- Research Aim 40: Improve understanding of agricultural intensification and diversification in later prehistory
- Research Aim 41: Assess the impact of the Roman empire on farming.

Theme H: Methodologies – developing new approaches and techniques

Roman

- Research Aim 3: Address apparent “gaps” in our knowledge and assess whether they are meaningful or simply biases in current knowledge

2.3 *Variation to site specific research priorities*

As the project proceeds through different phases, additional research objectives and opportunities may arise. These should be formulated with reference to the South West Archaeological Research Framework (SWARF), and in discussion with Orion Heritage and the Wiltshire Council Archaeological Advisor. This should be documented to ensure that the evolution of the Research questions is recorded.

3 Site specific methodology

3.1 *Background*

3.1.1 A unique site code has been agreed with the local Museum and/or Archive Receiving body.

3.1.2 The excavation areas and trenches will be set out by MOLA using a Leica Survey Grade RTK GPS operating to an accuracy of +/-0.05m to Ordnance Survey National Grid and Datum based on a shapefile supplied by Taylor Wimpey/Orion.

3.1.3 All excavation will be carried out in accordance with and/or guided by the CIfA *Standard and Guidance for Archaeological Excavation* and all Historic England guidelines where appropriate.

3.1.4 The Excavation Strategy will also follow the Management of Recording Projects in the Historic Environment: MORPHE principles (Historic England 2015) and abide the CIfA code of conduct (updated 2022).

3.2 *Excavation (digging)*

3.2.1 There are residential properties and farm buildings adjacent to the excavation areas and public footpaths and bridleways cross the site. Excavation will commence following appropriate measures to restrict unauthorised access to the excavation areas with appropriate signage in place.

3.2.2 To avoid unnecessary impacts on protected species as outlined in the Pre-Construction Information: Archaeology Excavation Works document section 4.7, removal of topsoil will either take place at an appropriate time of year (such as avoiding breeding seasons) or under supervision from a suitably qualified Ecologist (GHPC Group Ltd, May 2024, section 4.7).

3.2.3 The topsoil and any overburden will be removed using an appropriately sized excavator with a toothless bucket. The excavation will be carried out under the constant supervision of an appropriately experienced and qualified archaeologist. The removal of this overburden will be done in 5-10cm spits down to either the top of the uppermost archaeological horizon, or where absent the upper interface of geological deposits.

3.2.4 It is envisaged that for the majority of the excavation area a 20-tonne machine will be most appropriate. All machine excavation will be undertaken by competent personnel supplied by a specialised subcontractor, who will have prior experience of archaeological works. The stripping will be overseen by an experienced Project Officer or similar grade to ensure the overburden is removed without damage to archaeological deposits. In the areas underneath pre-existing overhead electric cables a smaller excavator will be used, with a height restrictor fitted on the excavator's arm.

3.2.5 Following the excavation of the overburden the area will be cleaned to enhance the definition of features. These will then be surveyed using a GPS system to produce a base plan. This pre-excavation base plan will be used to locate, target and quantify the required interventions (see 3.9.2 below)

3.2.6 All structures, deposits and finds will be recorded according to accepted professional standards.

3.2.7 Individual descriptions of all archaeological strata and features exposed or excavated will be entered onto MOLA's digital recording system which

includes digital context sheets, digital sample recording sheets, digital sample registers and digital finds recording sheets.

3.2.8 All archaeological remains will be hand excavated in an archaeologically controlled and stratigraphic manner sufficient to meet the aims and objectives of the project. The complete stratigraphic sequence, down to naturally occurring deposits will be excavated and the work will investigate and record all inter-relationships between features. If any deep features are encountered appropriate shoring/or stepping will be carried out to allow full excavation of the feature.

3.2.9 All exposed archaeological features must be investigated and as a minimum:

Feature Type	**Minimum percentage of each example**
Stake-hole	100%
Post-hole or pit (less than 1.5m)	50%
Pit (greater than 1 .5m)	50%
Linear feature (less than 5m) All terminals and intersections will be excavated along with any relationship with other features	20%
Linear feature (greater than 5m) All terminals and intersections will be excavated along with any relationship with other features	10%
Deposits relating to funerary activity e.g. burials, cremation deposits	100% (subject to agreement with curator)
Deposits relating to domestic/industrial activity (postholes, hearths, floor surfaces/floor makeup deposits)	100%
Agricultural pits and features	50%
Agricultural linear features e.g. ditches/gullies, paths/tracks All terminals and intersections will be excavated	For prehistoric features: 20% For Roman and later features: 10%

3.2.10 Where archaeological features are hand-drawn, this will be at an appropriate scale, normally 1:10 for sections and 1:20 for plans. Following section recording, where appropriate the remaining percentage of the feature will be excavated.

3.2.11 Should the above percentage excavation not yield sufficient information to allow the form and function of archaeological features/deposits to be determined full excavation of such features/deposits will be required. Additional excavation may also be required for the taking of palaeoenvironmental samples and recovery of artefacts.

3.2.12 If excavations reveal a substantial number of repetitive discrete features, such

as stake-holes, Wiltshire Council would require that these should be adequately sampled by excavation to understand their character rather than the complete excavation of all such features. Any variation to the number of repetitive discrete features must be agreed with Wiltshire Council's archaeologist.

3.2.13 MOLA will employ the in-house APEX digital recording system for the archival preservation of the excavated and the other recorded features from the fieldwork, which will form the basis for the data for the written post-excavation assessment and the archive to be deposited with the receiving museum (see also section 3.5).

3.3 *Ground Investigation works*

3.3.1 The archaeological watching brief will comprise the continuous observation of inspection pits for the various ground investigation (GI) works, including boreholes and machine excavated test-pits. This will be followed by the investigation and recording of any archaeological features that are revealed. Other groundworks will be carried out under close monitoring by appropriately qualified and experienced MOLA staff. Should sensitive archaeological remains be identified within the test pits (e.g. human remains, industrial features, waterlogged remains, etc) then the test pits will be relocated away from these remains.

3.3.2 The GI works supervisor will be responsible for staking out, CAT scanning, and machine excavation/backfill of the test pits, under the supervision of a MOLA supervisor.

3.3.3 A toothless grading bucket will be used for the removal of topsoil and subsoil down to the final formation level or identified archaeological deposits.

3.3.4 Excavation and recording of any archaeological features/deposits identified will follow the same methodology as features identified within the excavation areas.

3.4 *Site survey*

3.4.1 All archaeological features will be located digitally. MOLA carries out site survey using differential GNSS / GPS and optical Total Station systems, as appropriate. Site control is tied into Ordnance Survey National Grid (OSGB36) and Ordnance Datum (OD), or client survey frameworks, as required. Plans be produced for these showing the location of all archaeological features. Archaeological feature pick-up, and area or trench set-out, is by differential GNSS / GPS, or by optical methods. Laser-scanning survey is similarly tied into the OS framework.

3.4.2 Standards of precision and accuracy are derived from the accepted standards of accuracy as used by chartered surveyors and defined by the Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors.

3.4.3 Sites where significant archaeological remains are uncovered will be tied in to the Ordnance Survey National Grid (OSGB36) by GPS or by establishing or tying-in to existing OS control networks. Tying site grids to features identified on OS mapping will only be used for sites without significant archaeological remains and where no qualitatively preferable survey solution is possible.

3.4.4 Archaeological features recorded directly by GNSS/GPS will be automatically located in 3D in Ordnance Survey Grid and Datum coordinates. Trench or

area locations set out using GNSS/GPS will similarly, be located in relation to Ordnance Survey coordinates. Laser-scan and digital photogrammetric surveys will be tied into survey control frameworks located in relation to Ordnance Survey Grid and Datum.

3.4.5 Archaeological features will be plotted on an overall plan at a scale of either 1:100 or 1:50. Areas of significant remains or areas of complex stratigraphy will be planned in greater detail at 1:20 or 1:10 scale as appropriate. Plans and sections will include context numbers and Ordnance Datum (OD) spot heights for all principal strata and features.

3.5 *Photographic records*

3.5.1 A photographic record of the project will be maintained. This will comprise digital images, illustrating the detail and context of the principal features and finds discovered. The photographic record will also include working shots to illustrate more generally the progress of the programme of archaeological works. All digital images generated by the project will be deposited with the Archaeological Data Service (ADS).

3.5.2 The photographic record will illustrate all significant phases, structures, important stratigraphic and structural relationships, and individual items of interest, including artefacts.

3.5.3 Digital photography will be undertaken using cameras with a minimum 18 megapixel specification.

3.5.4 All site photographs, except 'working shots', will include a photographic scale of appropriate size.

3.5.5 A digital register of all photographs will be kept recording photo id, direction of shot and what the photograph is of, and size of scale and date the photograph was taken.

3.6 *Digital systems*

3.6.1 MOLA makes use of the latest digital operating systems, MSOffice applications, digital survey equipment, digital cameras, and CAD packages. These are upgraded continuously. Current details can be provided on request.

3.6.2 MOLA employs an in-house system for fieldwork records management, APEX. Our database structure has been developed specifically for archaeological data captured using the single context recording system. MOLA maintains and is continuously developing its sophisticated archaeological GIS. Details can be provided on request.

3.6.3 Security Backups of the entire system are done on a daily basis. All backup media is stored off site at a secure location.

3.7 *Artefacts and ecofacts from site*

3.7.1 Should deposits be exposed that contain palaeoenvironmental or datable elements appropriate sampling and post-excavation analysis strategies will be initiated. The project will be organised so that specialist consultants who might be required to conserve or report on finds or advise or report on other aspects of the investigation (e.g. palaeoenvironmental analysis) can be called upon and undertake assessment and analysis of such deposits – if required.

3.7.2 On-site sampling and post-excavation assessment and analysis will be

undertaken in accordance with Historic England's guidance in Environmental Archaeology: a guide to the theory and practice of methods, from sampling and recovery to post-excavation.

3.7.3 If any palaeoenvironmental rich deposits that might require monolith samples and subsequent C14 dating or any deposits suitable for OSL dating, provision will be made for a MOLA geoarchaeologist to attend site to carry out this work.

3.7.4 If any hearth deposits are encountered archaeomagnetic dating will be carried out by the MOLA geomatics team.

3.7.5 A site-specific sampling strategy will be developed once the archaeological features have been mapped and will be done so in conjunction with Wiltshire Council Archaeological advisor and the South West Regional Science Advisor.

3.7.6 Sample size will be based upon the reason for collecting the sample. Normally 40 litres for a 'general' bulk sample or 20 litres for a 'specialist' waterlogged sample for palaeoenvironmental analysis only. Some deposits - e.g. a waterlogged prehistoric settlement feature - might thus require both types of sample and this will be established through liaison with MOLA environmental archaeologists

3.7.7 Animal bone will be collected by hand, and this will be supplemented by the residues from bulk environmental samples

3.7.8 Human burials will be recovered individually, with the separate parts of the body (ie right arm, torso, left leg etc.) bagged separately on site. Samples will be taken for analysis of the abdominal area if soil conditions are wet or moist. Control samples will also be taken by consultation with the appropriate specialist. Cremations will be excavated in consultation with specialists.

3.7.9 Environmental procedures will be monitored throughout the excavation, and modified where necessary, eg after the discovery of unexpected features or deposit types, after consultation between the Project Manager and/or Site Supervisor and the appropriate specialist. In some circumstances advice may also be sought from an English Heritage Regional Science Advisor.

3.7.10 Metal detecting will be carried out across all excavated areas and spoil heaps. Details will be provided of the machine being used and the metal detecting will be undertaken by an experienced operative. The machine will be set to not discriminate against ferrous objects. If may be possible for involvement from local metal detecting groups and if deemed appropriate, contact should be made with the local Finds Liaison Officer to obtain contact details.

3.7.11 All finds will be exposed, lifted, cleaned, conserved, marked, bagged and boxed in accordance with the guidelines set out in the UK Institute for Conservation's Conservation Guideline No 2 (UKIC 1983). Appropriate guidelines set out in the Museums and Galleries Commissions Standards in the Museum Care of Archaeological Collections (1992) will also be followed.

3.7.12 Artefact and ecofact data recovery methods may include hand collection, and both intentional and incidental collection through the application of sampling procedures.

3.7.13 Different sampling strategies may be employed according to site specific research aims and the perceived importance of the deposits or features under investigation. Where appropriate alternative site-specific sampling strategies will be agreed by the Project Manager, Site Supervisor and/or relevant specialist. Sample size will account for the frequency with which material is likely to occur.

3.7.14 All retained finds and samples will be lifted, cleaned, conserved, marked, bagged and boxed in a proper manner and to standards agreed with local

Museum and/or Archive Receiving Body (Swindon Borough Council 2022).

3.7.15 Finds and Environmental work will normally be carried out by MOLA specialists in accordance with MOLAs environmental sampling policy. Where external specialists are necessary, eg dendrochronology, relevant method statements will be supplied if requested. All work will be carried out in accordance with CIfA standards and established national guidelines.

3.7.16 Human remains: If human remains are present, these will be 100% excavated. A license has previously been obtained from the Department of Justice (Coroner's Division). All works will comply with environmental health regulations, Coroner's permission, and if appropriate, in compliance with the Disused Burial Grounds (Amendment) Act 1981 or other local Act. Adequate site security will be provided. Where necessary the excavation will be screened from public view.

3.7.17 Treasure: all finds of gold and silver, or other objects definable as 'treasure', will be removed to a safe place and reported to the local Coroner according to the procedures of the Treasure Act 1996 and the Treasure (Designation) Order 2002. Where removal cannot be effected on the same working day as the discovery suitable security measures will be taken to protect the finds from theft

3.7.18 There will be regular liaison between appropriate MOLA specialists and the Project Manager and/or Site Supervisor during the course of the excavation. On larger, or finds- and environmentally-rich sites, this may take the form of a MOLA specialist working on site as part of the excavation team, or visiting regularly. The purpose of such liaison to provide the Site Supervisor and Project Manager with information they need to review and, if necessary, revise excavation and/or sampling strategies.

3.7.19 Handover of areas: It is expected that the east end of the excavation area will be completed first, and the contractor may wish to begin works in this area following completion of archaeological works. If this is the case an application will be made in writing including a drawing showing the full extent of the area in question. No areas will be 'signed-off' without permission of Wiltshire Council's archaeologist.

3.8 *Ownership of finds*

3.8.1 Whereas ownership of any finds on the site lies with the landowner, it will be necessary that the landowner gives necessary legal approvals, licences and permissions to donate the finds to the Swindon Museum and Art Gallery, to enable that body to carry out its obligations to curate the finds after discovery, in perpetuity, as part of the archaeological Archive from this site.

3.8.2 These approvals, licences and permissions shall be *either* confirmed in the Agreement and Contract regulating the archaeological works *and/or* confirmed by the completion of the relevant Deed of Transfer form (draft appended).

3.8.3 In such case, the client (or their agent) will make arrangements for the signing of the Deed of Transfer Form by the client or, if the landowner is different to the client, by the landowner.

3.8.4 Notwithstanding the above, subsequent arrangements may be made if required between the landowner and/or the client and the local Museum and/or Archive Receiving Body for the conservation, display, provision of access to or loan of selected finds in or near their original location.

3.9 *Interim storage and processing facilities*

3.9.1 Prior to final deposition of the archive, the storage and processing facilities available to MOLA can be summarised as follows:

3.9.2 Excavated finds and samples will be held at one of MOLA's two principal premises. These premises meet the *Standards in the Museum Care of Archaeological Collections* (MGC 1992).

3.9.3 Paper and digital records are initially stored in appropriate environmental conditions at MOLA's offices. Buildings have 24-hour security.

3.9.4 Cold and wet storage appropriate for organic finds and samples is provided at MOLA's principal premises.

3.9.5 Both dry and wet processing facilities are available at MOLA's principal premises.

3.10 *The project archive*

3.10.1 The Project Archive will include all materials retained (or the comprehensive record of such materials as referred to above) and all written, drawn and photographic records relating directly to the investigations undertaken. It will be quantified, ordered, indexed and internally consistent before transfer to the Swindon Museum and Art Gallery.

3.10.2 Given the scale of the project it is anticipated that the deposition of the archive with the museum will be in stages, reflecting the publication stages set out above, however all depositions will be under the same accession number.

3.10.3 The Swindon Museum and Art Gallery has been informed of the programme of works and intention to deposit the archive before the archaeological advisor discharges the archaeological condition.

3.10.4 The agreed accession code will be used in relation to the archive generated for each phase, which will relate to the post-excavation works for that part of the site. A separate accession number will be obtained from Swindon Museum & Art Gallery for each subsequent phase of archaeological excavation work that will result in a post-excavation assessment. This is to ensure that the deposited archive clearly relates to a discreet set of assessment and published data, to facilitate future reuse of the archive.

3.10.5 MOLA will prepare the archaeological archive to the standards described in Guidelines and conditions for the preparation and deposition of archaeological archives (Swindon Borough Council 2022). Any box fees required by the recipient museum will be the responsibility of MOLA.

3.10.6 The archive will be presented to the appropriate Archive Officer following the completion of any publication work (unless alternative arrangements have been agreed in writing with the Local Planning Authority).

3.10.7 The digital archive will be deposited with the Archaeological data service (ADS) as per the digital management plan detailed in Appendix 4.

3.10.8 The archive will consist of two elements, the artefactual (The 'Material (Finds) Archive') and digital – the latter comprising all born-digital data and digital copies made of the primary site records and images.

3.10.9 The post-excavation assessment reports produced for each phase must set out a timetable for the deposition of the site archive. The archaeological advisor would normally expect this to be completed within six months of completion of the fieldwork element of the project.

3.10.10 The Swindon Museum & Art Gallery requires that the digital archive (consisting of born-digital and digital copies of relevant written and drawn data produced during fieldwork) must be transferred into the care of a Trusted Digital Repository which will be ADS, rather than to the museum. A copy of the ADS/OASIS acceptance form should be included in the paper archive.

3.10.11 As MOLA are utilising digital recording it is not anticipated that there will be a large paper archive however any documents that are produced will be deposited in accordance with the Guidance produced by Swindon Museum & Art Gallery and at the very least two hard copies of the report will be provided.

4 Post-excavation reporting

4.1.1 Following the completion of field work, an interim report will be produced summarising the results of the excavation areas and will include plans of those areas and showing their relationship with the Primary Street Area and all associated archaeological features. This will be completed within 3 months of finishing the fieldwork outlined in this WSI.

4.1.2 This will comprise a basic description of the archaeology, including a general description of the site stratigraphy, provisional dating of finds, general plans and sections of the site and of key features within it as well as details of short-term archiving arrangements and subsequent post-excavation works.

4.1.3 Following completion of the interim report, MOLA will produce the initial post-excavation assessment of the site records and finds which will be due within six months of finishing fieldwork, unless otherwise agreed in writing with the archaeological advisor. This will include a proposal for *Updated Project Design* in accordance with 'Appendix 4: assessment report specification' in The Management of Archaeological Projects (English Heritage, 1991).

4.1.4 The Post Excavation Assessment Report will include:

- An Abstract summarising the scope and results of the archaeological investigation;
- An introduction including:
  - The location of the site including a National Grid Reference for the centre sufficient to locate the site to 1m accuracy;
  - An account of the background and circumstances of the work;
  - A description of the development proposals, planning history, and planning reference together with the planning condition;
  - The nature of potential impacts arising from the proposals;
  - The scope and date of the fieldwork, the personnel involved and who commissioned it.
- An account of the archaeological background of the development site including:
  - Geology, soils and topography;
  - Any known existing disturbances on the site;
  - The background archaeological potential of the site including a summary of Historic Environment Record entries within 500m of the boundaries of the site;
  - A summary of previous phases of archaeological investigation;
  - Any constraints on the archaeological investigation.
- The methodology employed during the investigation. Specified aims and objectives will be included, as will any additional objectives identified during the course of the investigation;
- The report will include a quantification of the archive contents, their state and future location.
- A description of the results of the archaeological investigation which shall include:
  - The nature and depth of overburden soils encountered;

  - A description of the geological subsoil encountered across the site;
  - Description of all archaeological features and finds encountered, their dimensions, states of preservation and interpretation;
  - Heights related to Ordnance Datum will be provide for each feature and deposit;
  - For complex remains a Harris Matrix diagram may be provided.
- The finds recovered during the course of the investigation will be described, quantified and assessed by artefact type within the report. The report will also indicate the potential of each category of artefact for further analysis and research. Any implications for future archive, conservation or discard will also be considered including any specialist examination of key finds.
- The report will include a table showing the contexts, classes and quantity of artefacts recovered, together with their date and interpretation;
- The report will include an assessment of the environmental potential of the site. Details will be provided of any environmental sampling undertaken in connection with the fieldwork and the results of any processing and assessment of the samples. Any potential for future analysis of the samples or environmental remains recovered from the investigation will be described. Implications for future archive, conservation or discard of environmental samples or remains will be detailed.
- The report will include, as appropriate, tables summarising environmental samples taken, together with the results of processing and assessment;
- Any results from the application of scientific techniques e.g specialist dating will be included in the report;
- The assessment report will include an interpretation of the archaeology of the site. This will be a synthesis of the stratigraphic, finds and environmental results of the investigation and a consideration of the site in its wider context as appropriate. This section will be supported by a phased interpretative plan of the site, clearly showing the major areas and periods of archaeological activity.
- This report will also include an assessment of the results of the archaeological investigations and their potential to address both the original research aims and objectives of the project and any further research objectives identified during the course of the on-site and post excavation works.
- The report will include a detailed proposal for any further analysis necessary on the project records, artefact and environmental assemblages to achieve the research potential of the site. A justification will be included for each analysis proposed.
- The proposal will set out a timetable for completion of analysis and reporting, detailing all individual tasks to be completed, resources required, and the key personnel involved. The proposal will set out

arrangements for monitoring of the post-excavation process and will be provide in an Updated Project Design.

- The report will include a synopsis of the proposed 'Full Report' and 'Publication' and identify the likely destination of the publication.
- Figures should include the following:
  - A site location plan tied into the Ordnance Survey at 1:1250, including at least two National Grid points and show the site boundary;
  - a plan at 1:1250, or a scale to be agreed with the County Archaeologist, showing the layout of the development groundworks clearly indicating the areas investigated. The plan will show significant archaeological features, coloured by phases or period as related to the development site. This plan will also include two National grid points;
  - Plans of the features revealed in each of the investigation areas at a larger scale, e.g. 1:20 or 1:50; such plans are to also illustrate areas of disturbance, change in subsoil and location of sections; the location of significant finds and samples taken will also be indicated;
  - relevant section drawings as appropriate;
  - Illustrations and/or photographs of significant finds will be included where appropriate

4.2 *Publication/dissemination*

4.2.1 In all cases a short summary of the results of the work will be submitted to the NAR (using the appropriate OASIS archaeological report form), and for publication in the 'Excavation Round-up' of a local archaeological journal and/or other period-based archaeological journals as appropriate.

4.2.2 As a minimum, the final publication will comprise a monograph presenting the results, analysis and synthesis of all the archaeological investigations for the South Marston development as a whole. This will be based on the post-excavation assessment reports produced for each phase of archaeological investigation.

4.2.3 An updated project design will be produced and submitted to Wiltshire Council following completion of the Phase 4 post-excavation assessment report. This will be produced for the works undertaken for all 4 phases of the development. It is proposed that full publication will be within 2 years of completion of the last archaeological site works (Phase 4) and dissemination of excavation reports, of ALL phases of work. This is contingent upon all specialist work having been completed within that timescale.

4.2.4 The client has been made aware that completion of any such further analysis, publication and archive work recommended in the post-excavation assessment report is a necessary part of the fulfilment of the planning condition and that additional, as yet undefined, resources will need to be made available to achieve this.

5 Programme and resourcing

5.1 *Field programme*

5.1.1 The main excavations are likely to start in December 2024 and it is planned to run into the second quarter of 2025. MOLA staffing will consist of an appropriately qualified Senior Archaeologist or Project Officer and appropriate number of archaeologists according to the requirements of the fieldwork.

5.1.2 Time required for any engineering or enabling works before access to the areas is available will not be taken out of the agreed archaeological excavation period.

5.1.3 The time needed for watching briefs on temporary or enabling works as specified will be dependent on the programme of the Principal Contractors. The archaeological monitoring will be undertaken by a Site Supervisor with assistance from a second member of staff if required, and will last for the duration of such works. Attendance for such watching briefs will sometimes be intermittent at the discretion of the Site Supervisor.

5.1.4 If unforeseen engineering or health and safety problems should arise, or if extensive, significant deposits are found to survive in the area which cannot be satisfactorily excavated and recorded in this period, then there should be sufficient flexibility within the programme and resources to enable the deposits in question to be excavated and recorded to the satisfaction of the Local Planning Authority's designated representative/advisor. The exact details of time, areas and numbers of staff involved would be agreed in discussions between representatives of the developer and/or their agents, MOLA and the Local Planning Authority's designated representative/advisor.

5.2 *Post-excavation programming*

5.2.1 The time required to complete the *Post-excavation Assessment Report*, including an *Updated Project Design*, will depend on the volume of records generated during the excavation.

5.2.2 At this stage, MOLA intends that the report will be completed and submitted to the local planning authority's archaeological adviser/officer for consideration and agreement within six months of the completion of fieldwork.

5.2.3 The *Updated Project Design* will include an agreed timetable for completing a program of analysis, publication and archiving which will then be implemented to fully satisfy the planning condition.

5.3 *Attendance requirements*

5.3.1 This section provides a summary of likely attendance requirements to be provided for MOLA by the site Attendance Contractor during the archaeological excavations.

5.3.2 As part of the site preparation works fencing will be erected by the clients' fencing contractor. MOLA will work in the fenced areas.

5.3.3 A temporary compound will be constructed for MOLAs use.

5.3.4 After the completion of site preparation works there will be an on-site review to ensure that the on-site conditions are acceptable to the MOLA Project Manager and MOLA Health and Safety Officer.

5.3.5 MOLA will be responsible for all site welfare.

5.3.6 If groundwater is encountered in the excavation area, adequate pumps with generating equipment if needed will be required to remove it in order to complete the excavations.

5.3.7 A suitable security system to operate overnight, weekends and holidays. Normally this means adequate hoarding/Heras fencing and locks with a cctv system when plant is on site.

5.3.8 Effective channels of communication, including a designated supervising engineer and/or client's project manager to liaise with the Site Supervisor and Project Manager from MOLA. A designated contractor's agent will be necessary to implement agreed attendances.

5.3.9 Where archaeological remains are to be preserved *in situ* adequate protection will be supplied by the MOLA. This might involve for instance protective boxing; or wrapping deposits or features in a geo-textile such as Terram; or sealing with sand or other suitable soft materials; or other means as deemed suitable/appropriate at the time by the local authority.

5.3.10 MOLA's sub-contractor will be supplying all plant including excavators and dumpers, spoil management will follow an agreed spoil management plan issued and/or approved by the client or their agent.

6 Funding

6.1.1 Funding arrangements for the excavation, reporting and archiving have been agreed between MOLA and the developers/client, together with agreements for attendance requirements, accommodation and facilities required. It has been agreed that the developer will fund the on-site works up to the *Post-Excavation assessment* stage as defined by MoRPHE and as described in this document. Additional costs for the later analysis/publication programme will be confirmed following the completion of the *Post-excavation assessment report and Updated project design*, and the client is aware of this eventuality.

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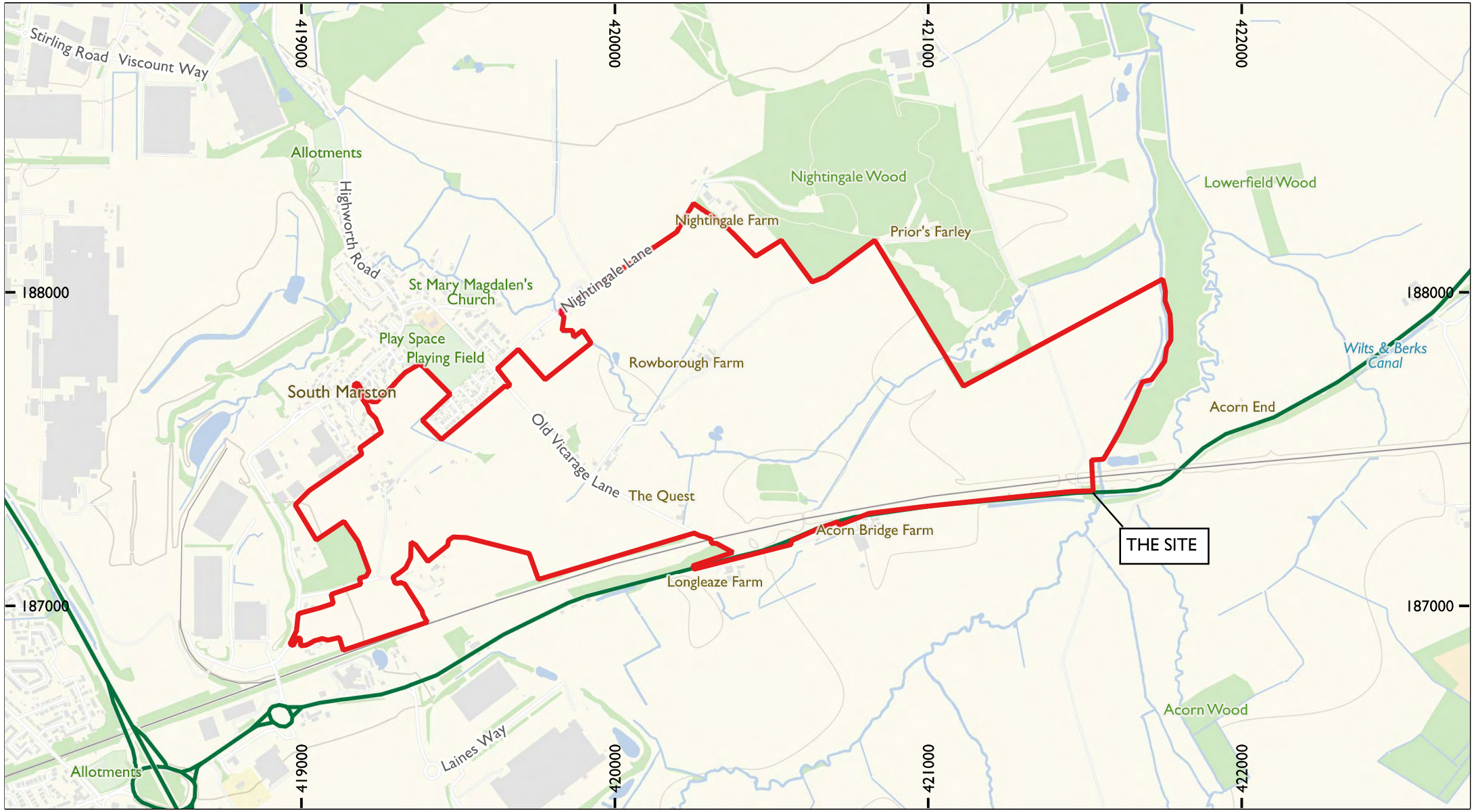
8 Figures

FIGURE 1 // Site Location - General



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PROJECT // 4955B - South Marston Overall Site

DESCRIPTION // Site Location

Contains OS data © Crown Copyright 2024 Open Government Licence 3.0

DOC REF: LP4955B-WSI-v1

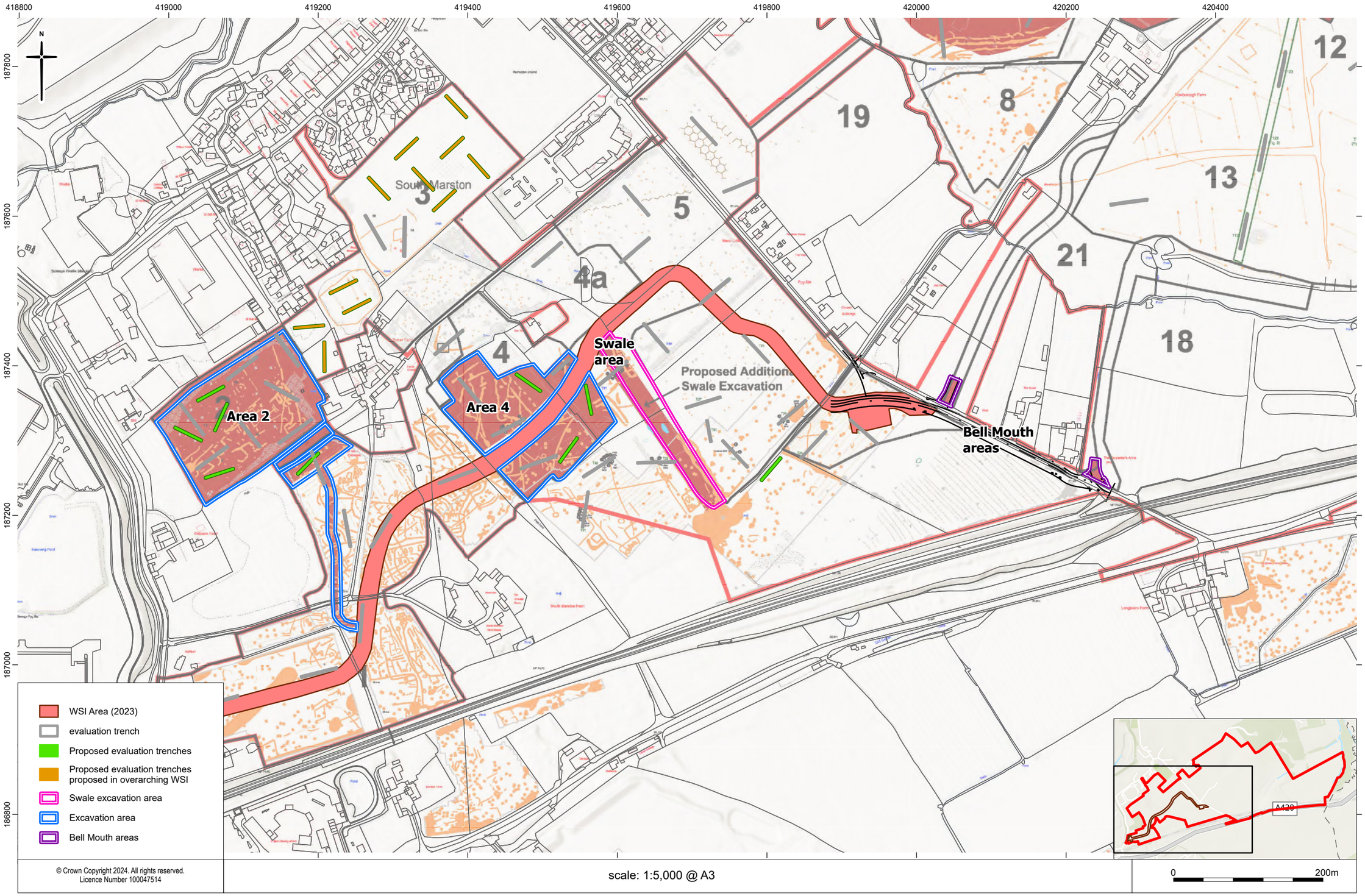
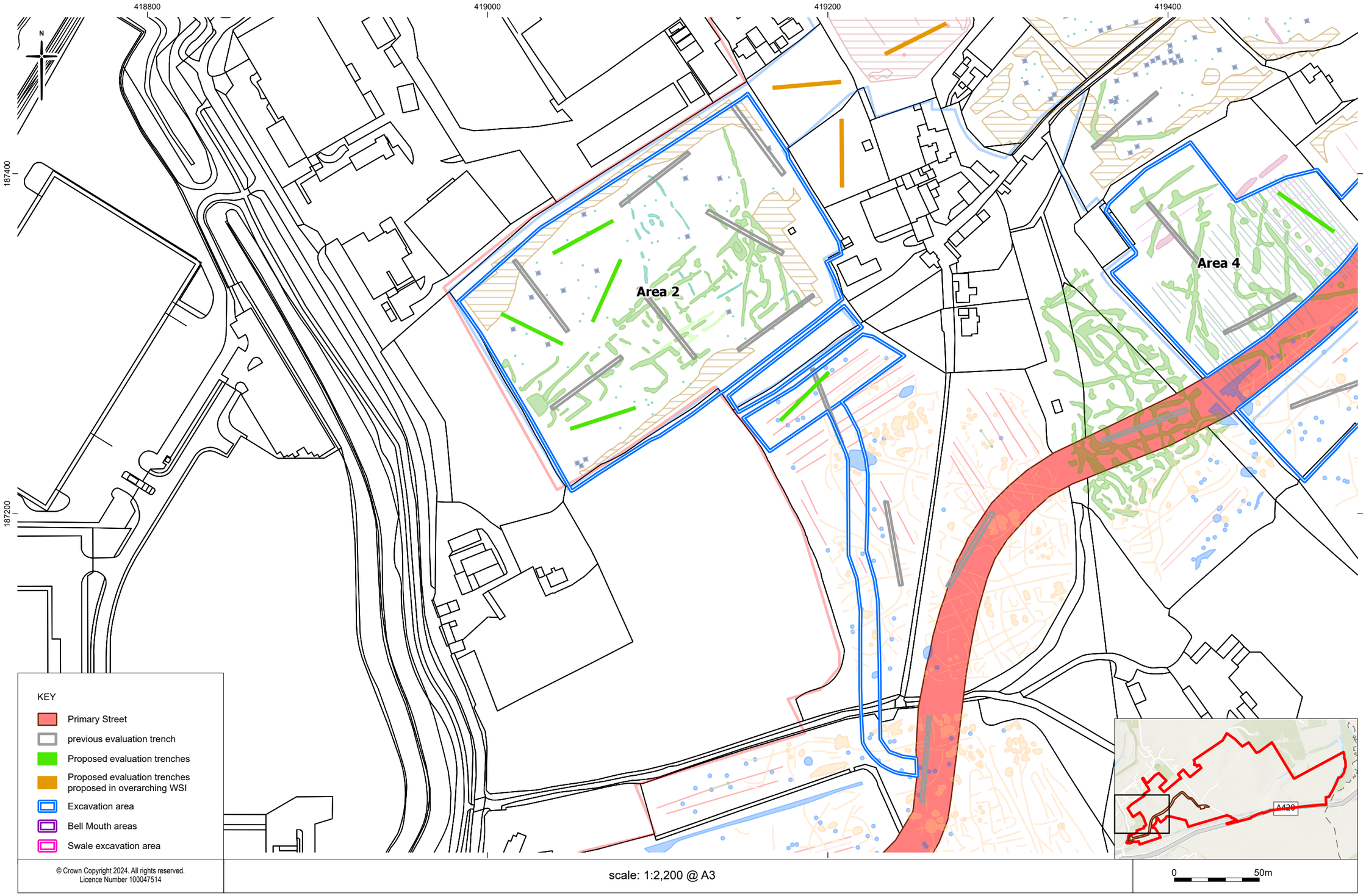


Fig 2 Evaluation trenches and excavation areas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419400
187400
187200
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Area 2
Area 4
A420
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Primary Street
previous evaluation trench
Proposed evaluation trenches
Proposed evaluation trenches proposed in overarching WSI
Excavation area
Bell Mouth areas
Swale excavation area
© Crown Copyright 2024. All rights reserved.
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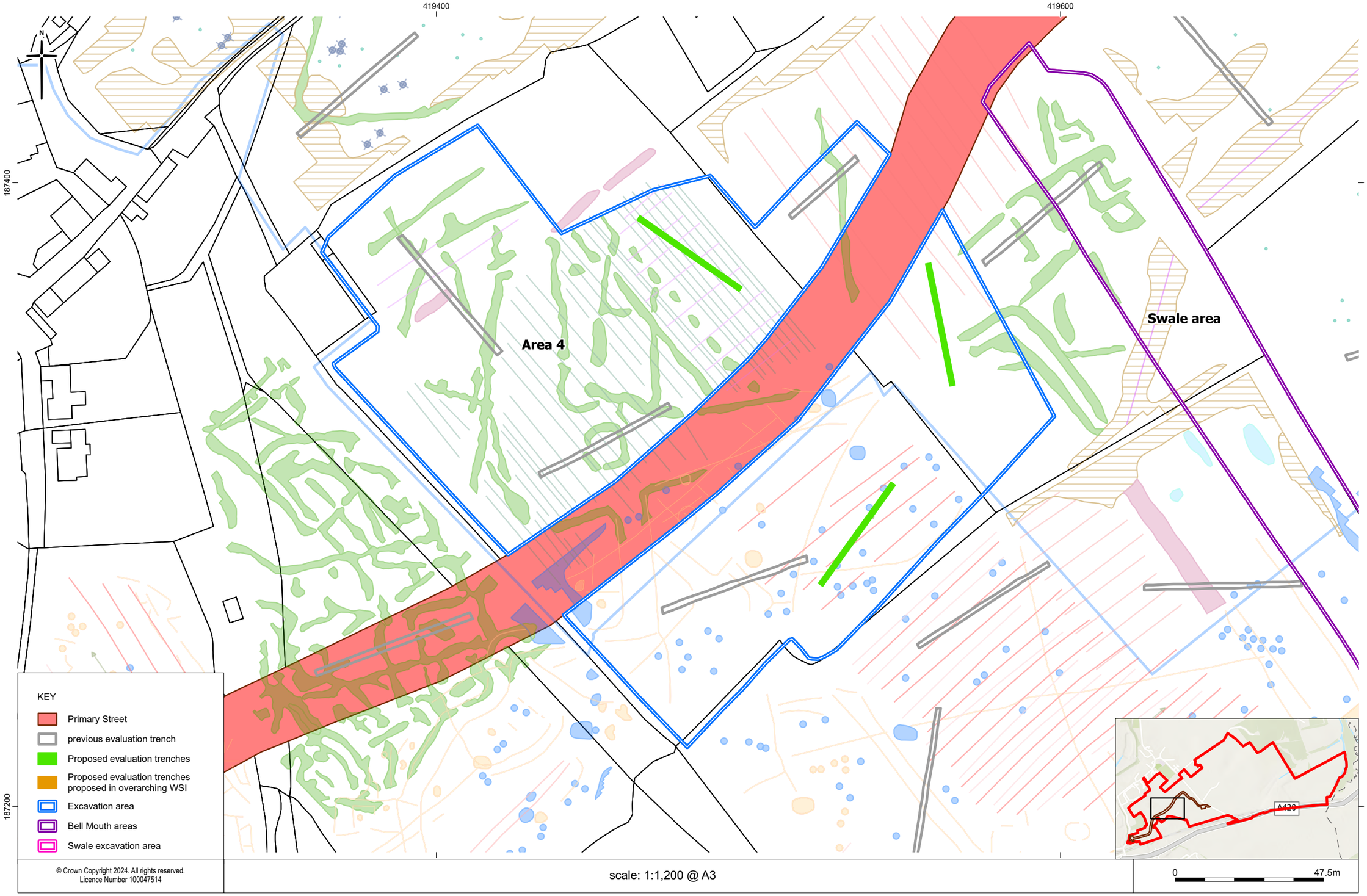
Fig 3 Area 2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Area 4
Swale area
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Primary Street
previous evaluation trench
Proposed evaluation trenches
Proposed evaluation trenches proposed in overarching WSI
Excavation area
Bell Mouth areas
Swale excavation area
A436
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Fig 4 Area 4

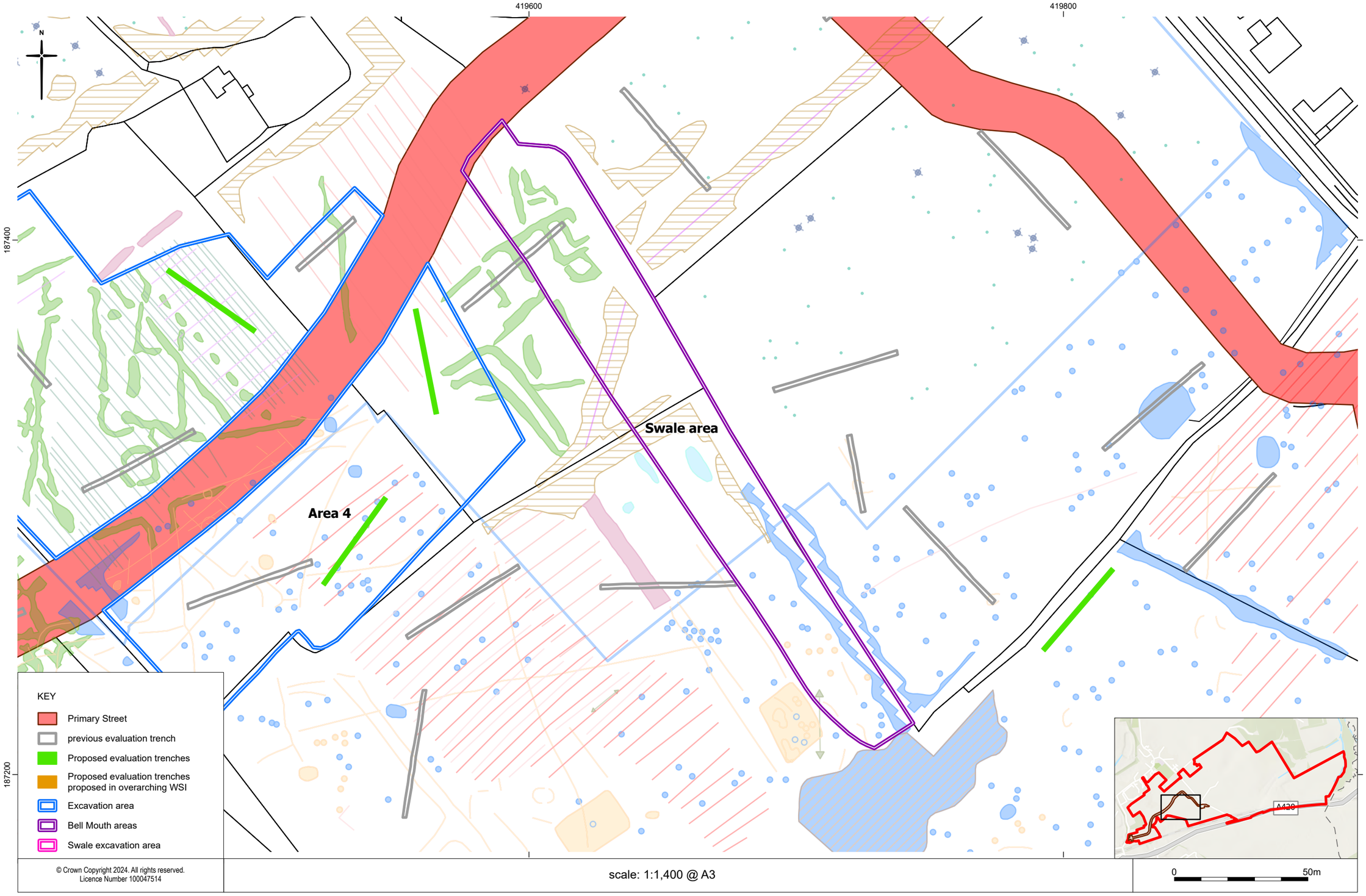


Fig 5 Swale area

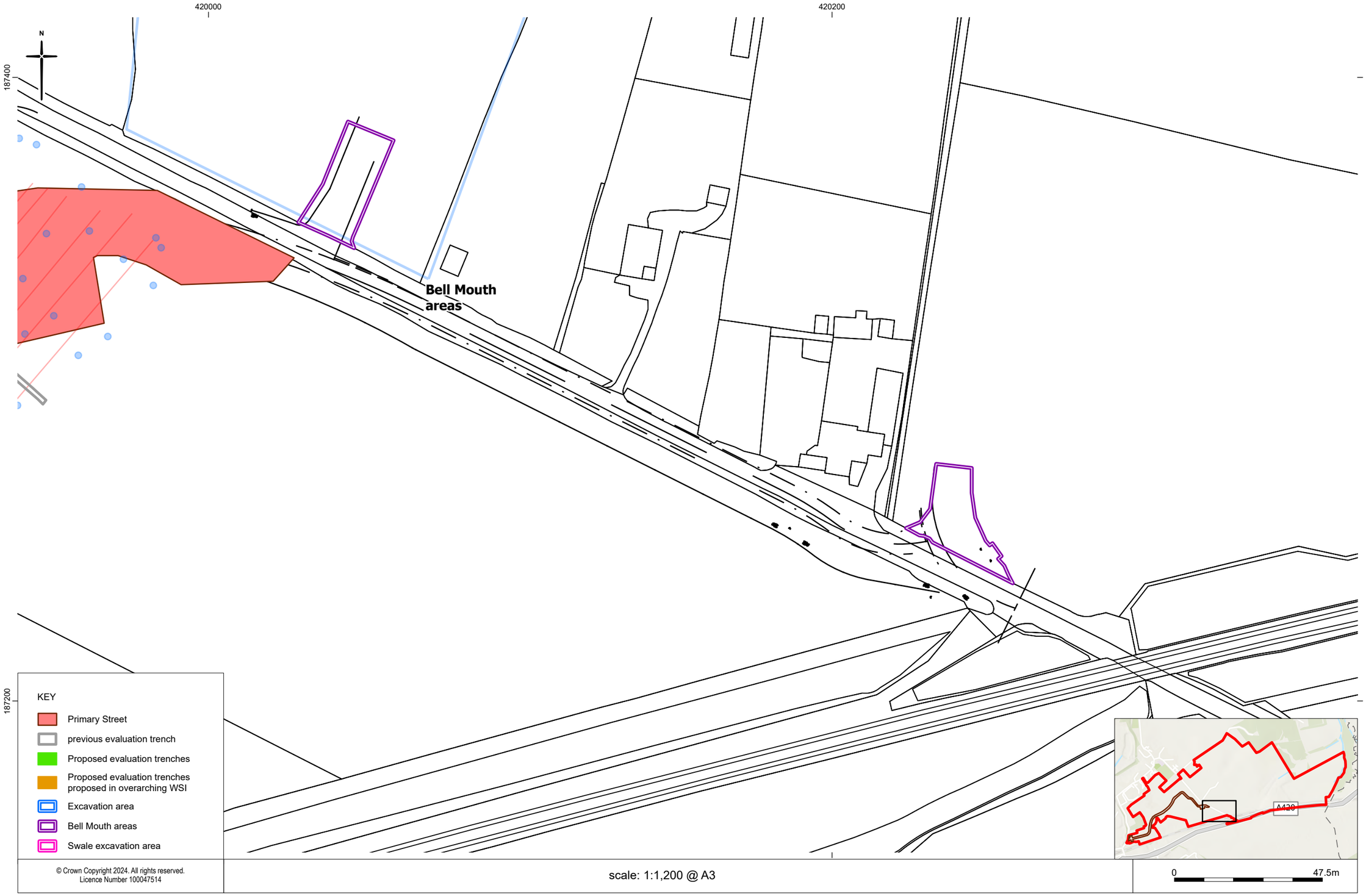


Fig 6 Bell Mouth areas

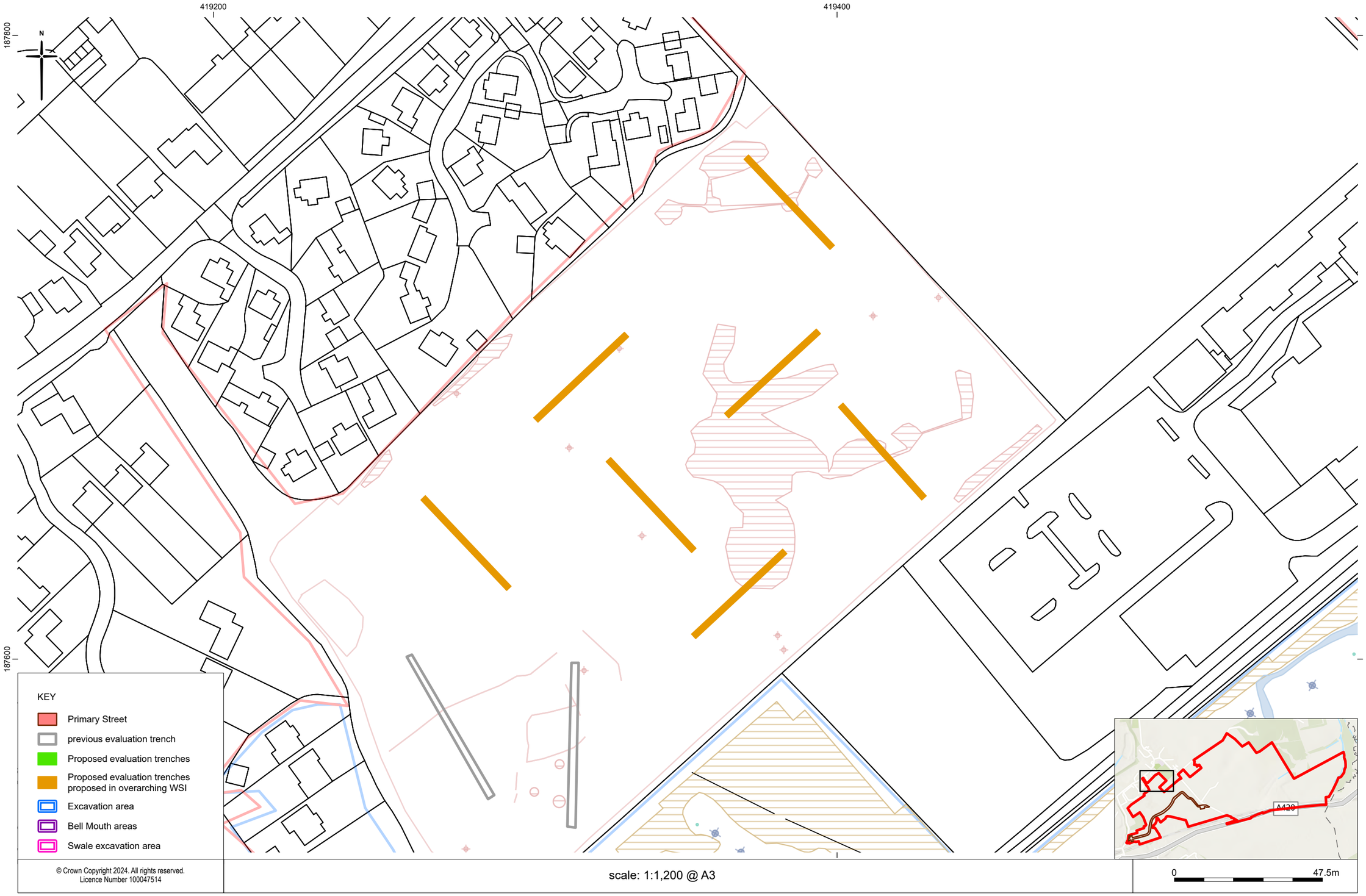


Fig 7 Proposed evaluation trenches covered in overarching WSI

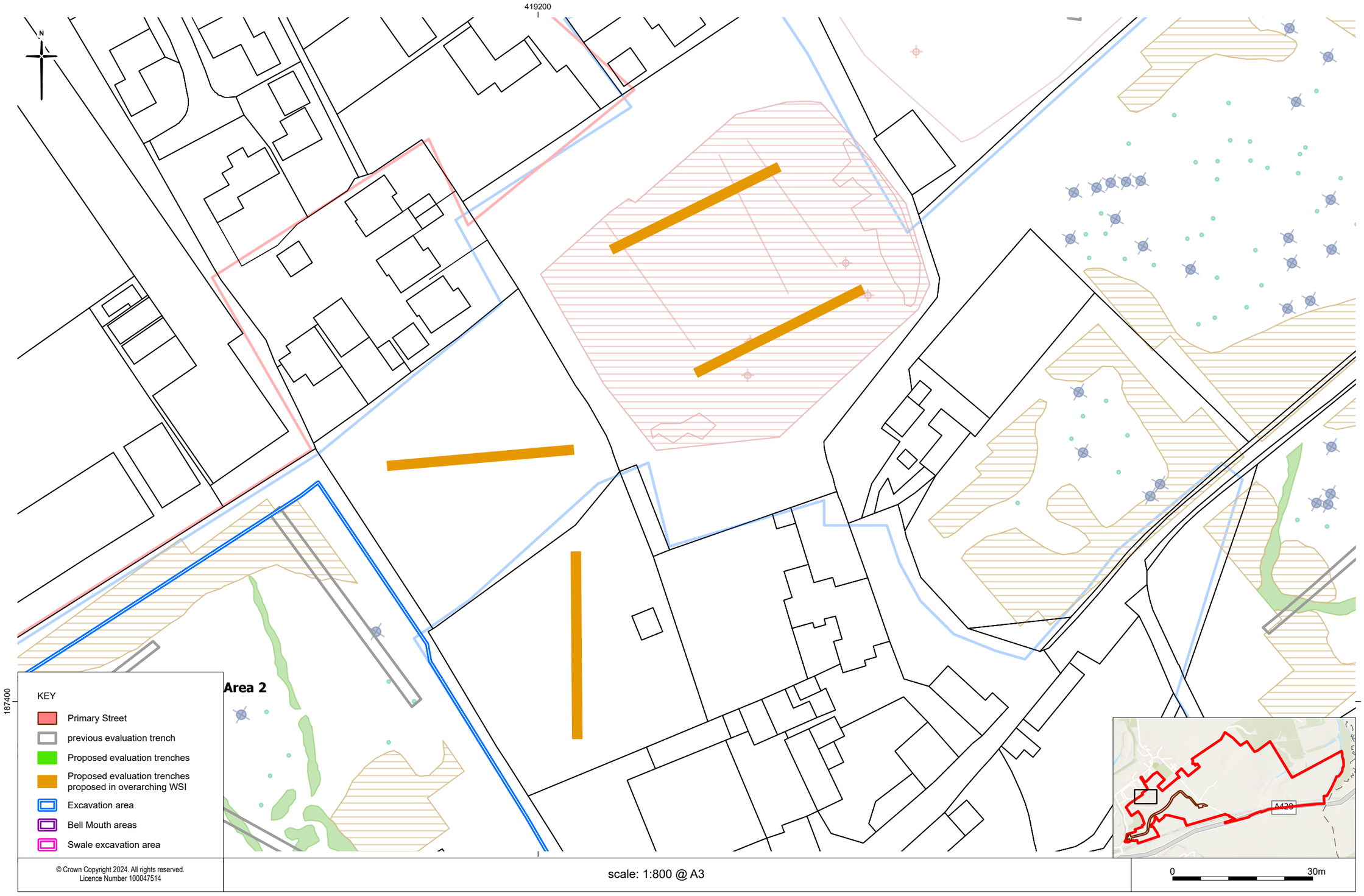


Fig 8 Proposed evaluation trenches covered in overarching WSI

Fig 9 Proposed evaluation trenches

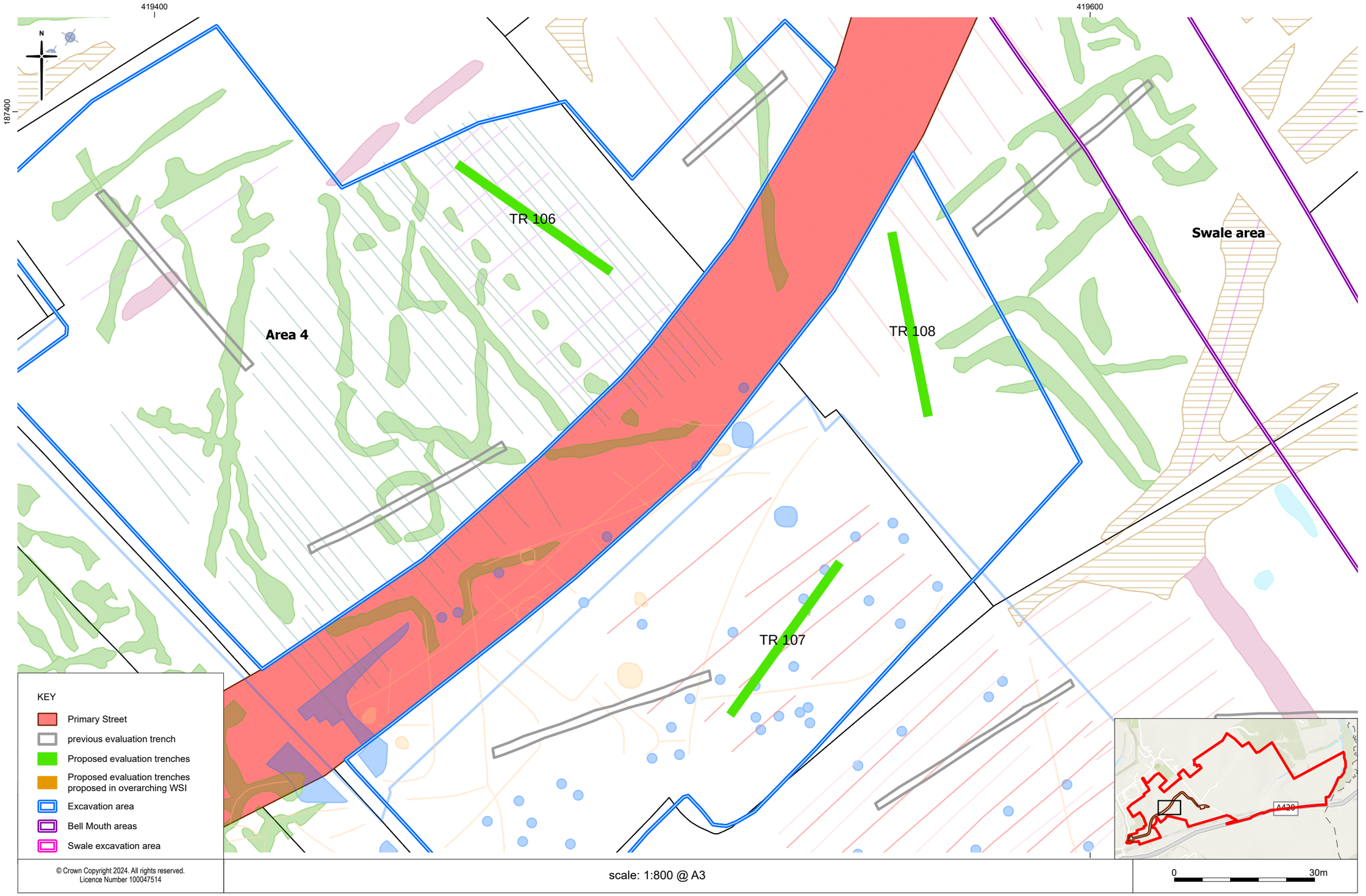


Fig10 Proposed evaluation trenches

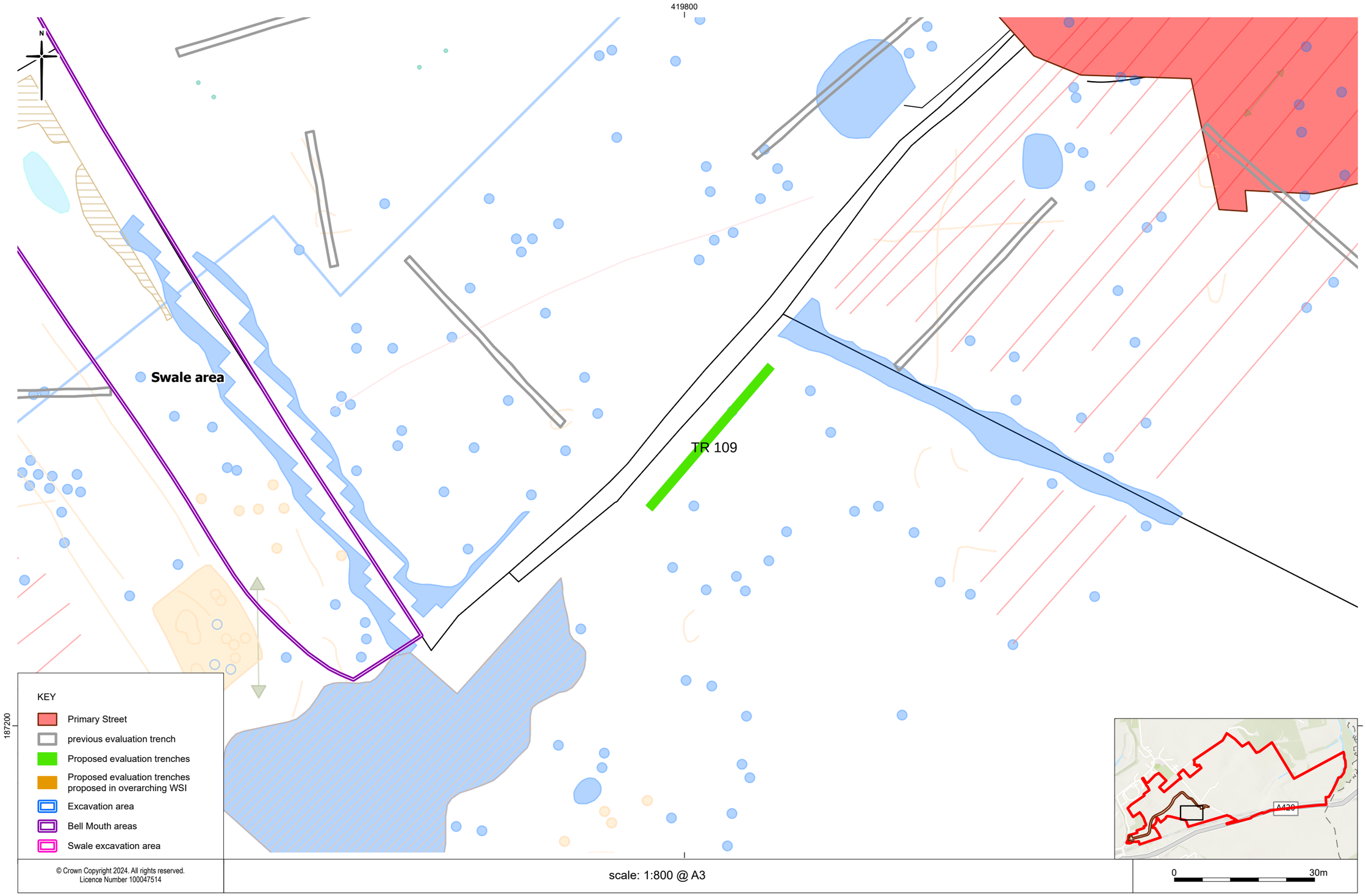
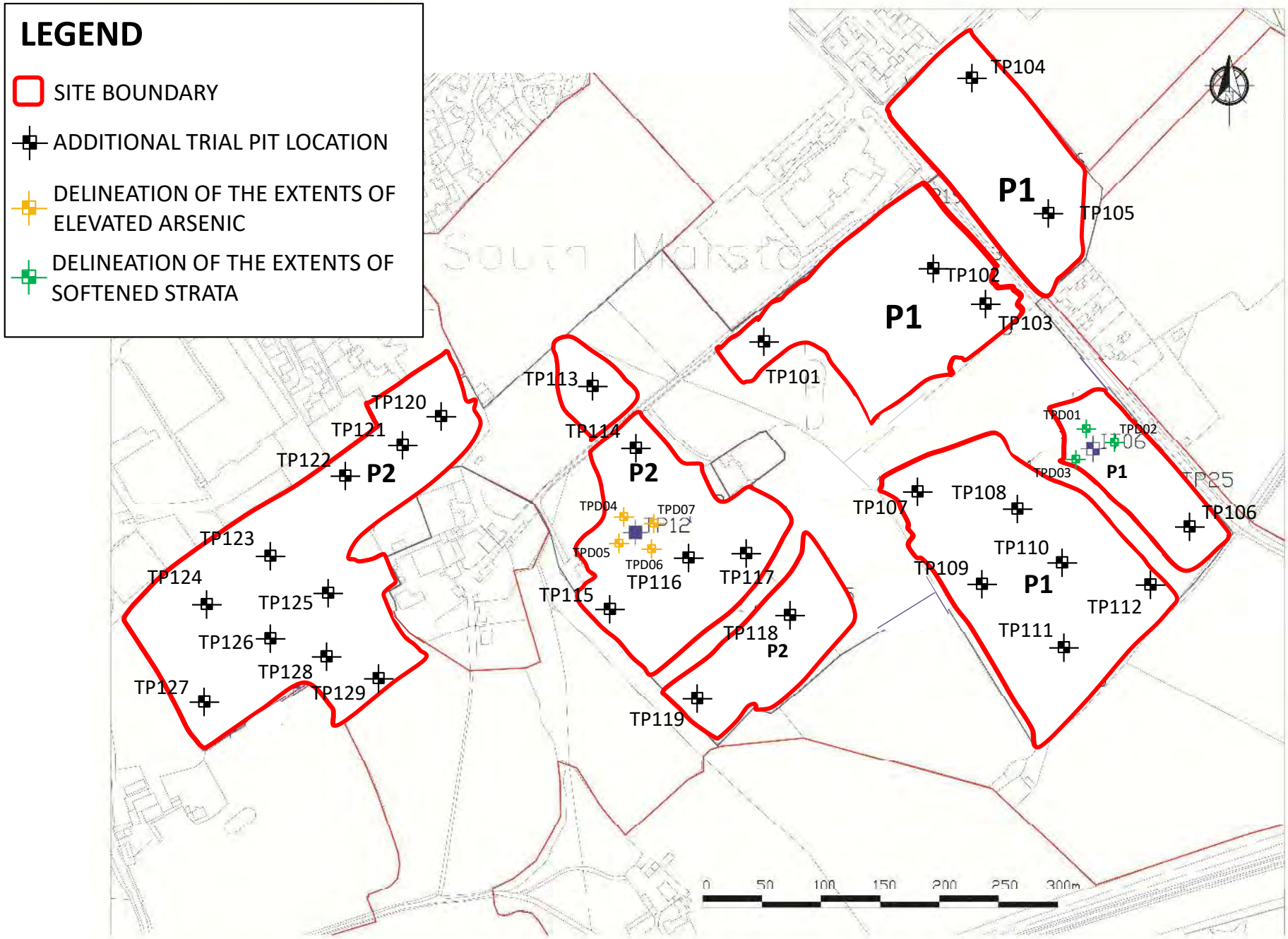
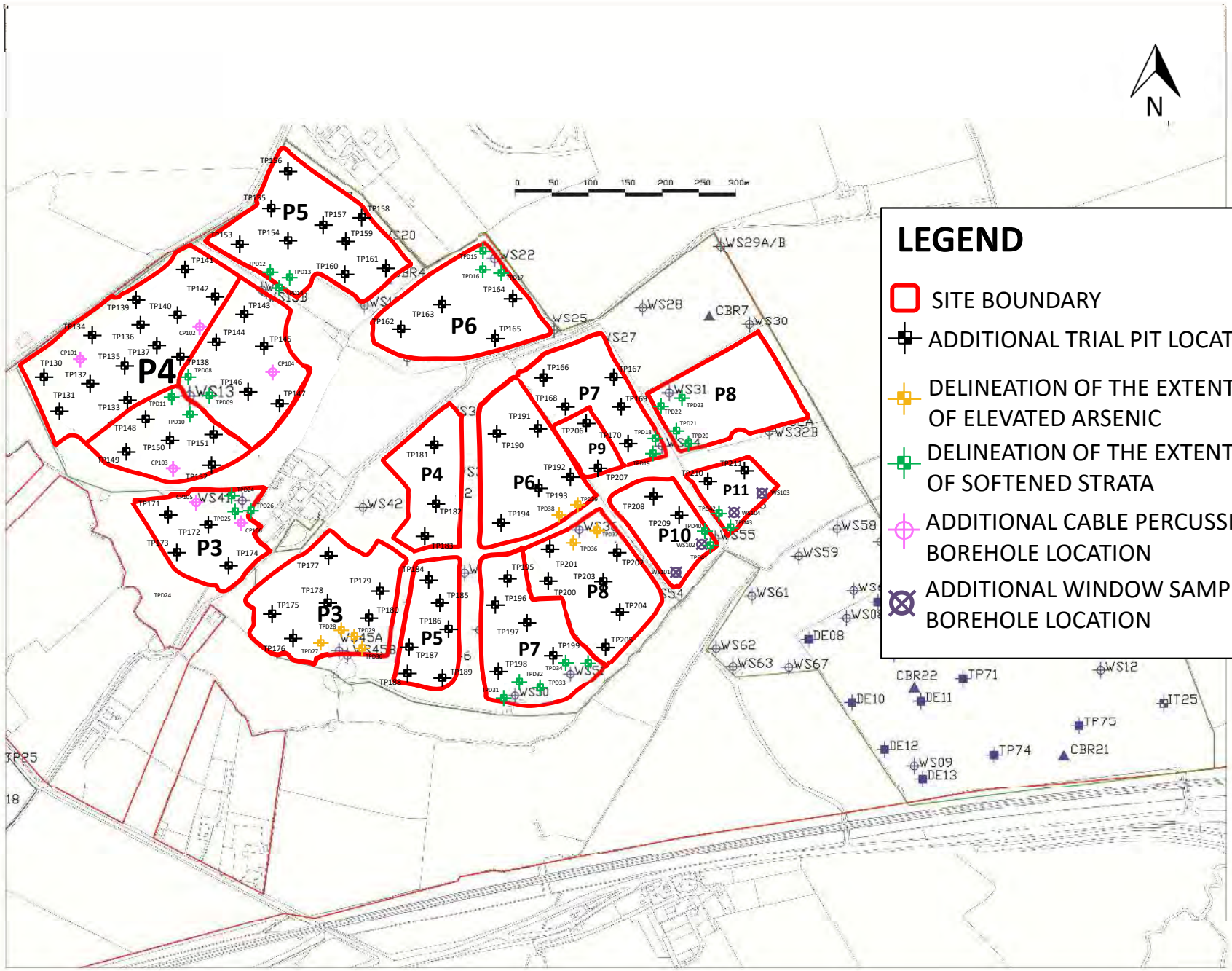


Fig 11 Proposed evaluation trenches



TITLE: FIGURE:12 PROPOSED LAYOUT PLAN	**CLIENT:** BROOKBANKS		**DRAWN/CHECKED:** EW / AM		GEG House, 17 Graham Road Malvern, WR14 2HR Tel. 01684 212526 admin@g-eg.co.uk, www.g-eg.co.uk
SITE: SWINDON NEV DEVELOPMENT	**PROJECT No.:** P-24-2092	**SCALE:** As shown	**DATE:** 09/10/24	**REVISION:** A	Geo Environmental Group



TITLE: FIGURE:13 PROPOSED LAYOUT PLAN	**CLIENT:** BROOKBANKS		**DRAWN/CHECKED:** EW / AM		GEG House, 17 Graham Road Malvern, WR14 2HR Tel. 01684 212526 admin@g-eg.co.uk, www.g-eg.co.uk
SITE: SWINDON NEV DEVELOPMENT	**PROJECT No.:** P-24-2092	**SCALE:** As shown	**DATE:** 18/10/24	**REVISION:** A	Geo Environmental Group

9 Appendix 1: Draft Transfer of finds ownership form

Sheet
of

Institution: transfer of title number

ACQUISITION

The museum gratefully acknowledges the acquisition into the collection of the items described below, from:

These items have been acquired by: _____ **date** _____

GROUP

group number | initial accession number

identity number | brief description

TRANSFER

In order to complete the transfer of title from you to the museum, we would be grateful if you could read the relevant notes overleaf and then sign this form. Please retain the first part of the form for your files and return the second part to the museum.

Museum officer: _____ **date:** _____

Depositor: _____ **date:** _____

We recommend that you keep the first part of this form in a secure place. It would help the museum if it could be produced in the event of any query concerning the acquisition or the items.

TRANSFER OF TITLE

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10 Appendix 2: Management, delivery and quality control

10.1.1 MOLA (Museum of London Archaeology) is a company limited by guarantee registered in England and Wales with company registration number 07751831 and charity registration number 1143574. Registered office: Mortimer Wheeler House, 46 Eagle Wharf Road, London N1 7ED). It has its own independent Board of Trustees but works in partnership with the Museum of London via a Memorandum of Understanding.

10.1.2 MOLA is a 'Registered Organisation' with the archaeological professional body, the Chartered Institute for Archaeologists (CIfA). The C*IfA Register* is a rigorous Quality Assurance scheme for archaeologists. In order to be accepted, MOLA has passed a Board resolution to comply with the CIfA Code of Conduct and Standards, to demonstrate that compliance through bi-annual re-registration, to submit to regular CIfA inspections, and to ensure that all MOLA activities are under the overall direction of a Member grade (MCifA) 'responsible post-holder'. The Registered Organisation scheme also provides procedures for investigating and handling of external complaints.

10.1.3 MOLA is currently working with a specialist consultant towards achieving an ISO9001 Quality Management standard (proof can be provided if required).

10.1.4 MOLA subscribes to and abides by the general principles and specific terms of the *Code of Good Practice On Archaeological Heritage in Urban Development Policies* established by the Cultural Heritage Committee of the Council of Europe, and adopted at the 15th plenary session in Strasbourg on 8-10 March 2000 (CC-PAT [99] 18 rev 3). In particular to the following points: ….*archaeologists shall be aware of development costs and adhere to agreed timetables* (Para 3 'The Role of the Archaeologist'), with all work *'carried out to written statements setting out standards timetables and costs'* (para 4 ibid).

10.1.5 MOLA further subscribes to and ensures that its activities comply with and/or are guided by the following policies, procedures and guidance:

- Appropriate local and regional planning authority archaeology guidance
- Appropriate Archaeological Research Framework for the region – eg South West Archaeological Research Framework
- English Heritage, *Management of Archaeological Projects* (MAP2), (1991)
- English Heritage Centre for Archaeology, *Guidelines* (various)
- National archive disposition standards including Museum and Galleries Commission, *Standards in the Museum Care of Archaeological Collections* (1992) and Society of Museum Archaeologists, *Towards an Accessible Archaeological Archive: the Transfer of Archaeological Archives to Museums: Guidelines for Use in England, Northern Ireland, Scotland and Wales* (1995)
- Relevant local archive deposition standards, Swindon Borough Council

10.1.6 MOLA governance and organisational strategy are determined by the Senior Management Group (SMG), led by the CEO and comprising the Finance Director, Chief Operating Officer, and five other Directors. The SMG reports regularly to an independent Board of Trustees, who oversee MOLA's performance and strategic direction. As a charitable company MOLA is monitored and regulated by the Charities Commission.

10.1.7 MOLA is structured to reflect its project orientation. A Director manages the

Client Team of Project Managers (PMs). Individual PMs are responsible for developing new work for MOLA, and thereafter for designing, budgeting and delivering projects for clients. They remain the principal point of contact for the client for the duration of each project.

10.1.8 PMs drive projects through successive stages in accordance with client needs, forming project teams by drawing upon the skills available within MOLA Operations teams. PMs ensure that projects are completed to the highest standards within time and budget. Financial monitoring of projects against budget is undertaken by the Finance Director and PMs at monthly review meetings. Project management software is employed by MOLA Operations to plan resourcing and track and adhere to programme and budget. Project team meetings are held throughout the programme, allowing refinement of research strategies in the light of on- or off-site findings or analysis. Recording, excavation, and sampling strategies may be modified to provide optimum information retrieval in support of the research objectives. At post-excavation phase internal project management is normally devolved to a designated Post-Excavation Project Manager.

10.1.9 All archaeological field work is controlled and monitored on a day to day basis by the on-site Site Supervisor (SS), who reports to the designated Project Manager. Together with PMs and the Field Manager (responsible for H&S) they also liaise as necessary with the client's agents and Principal Contractors regarding all enabling works and H&S..

10.1.10 All written documentation, eg initial *written scheme of investigations*, evaluation reports, post-excavation *Assessment Report*s and final publications undergo stages of internal review and sign-off prior to final issue to clients. For both field and reporting work PMs and SSs meet and liaise with the client and the Local Authority's archaeological advisor or officer to ensure delivery according to WSI and to review progress, research aims, archaeological procedures, and site strategies as appropriate..

10.1.11 At all stages, what constitutes an appropriate archaeological response will be assessed against criteria of local, regional and national significance and within frameworks of valuable archaeological research topics identified in local or regional Archaeological Research Frameworks (where these exist).

11 Appendix 3: Digital Management Plan

Project details	
Project Manager	Gwilym Williams
Project Name	South Marston – Primary Street
Project Finance Code	P24-414
Accession Code	
Project stages covered	Excavation of Primary Street
Related Policies	The project anticipates some deviation from MOLA's Data Management Procedure due to the fully digital recording strategy in place for this project. All data will comply with regional guidelines and ADS guidelines

Version control

Version	Author(s)	Date:	Status	Summary of Changes
1	D Taylor	28/05/2024	Draft	For comment

Data Collection/Creation	
Data to be Collected/Created	All file formats created will meet the standards set out in MOLA's Data Management Procedure and Fieldwork Manual. • The digital documentary archive for this phase of works will consist of: - Text: PDF/A documents comprising completed site report, WSI, Brief - Spreadsheets: extracted ORACLE data, including site records and registers - Survey data: GIS shp files - Illustration files: AutoCAD DWG, PDF/A, MapInfo files - Image files: JPEG and high quality non-proprietary raw files (DNG) /TIFF and - Metadata files for the above • The recording of archaeological horizons, and all archaeological contexts encountered will be made as digital records on site. Digital registers will be made to record contexts, digital photos, drawings, samples, levels, burials, small finds, sketch plans and masonry, as appropriate. The data will be entered into the site's ORACLE CDE database directly through the APEX portal on site. • Overall photographic shots of the site and each excavation area will be taken prior to excavation and after backfilling, with detailed shots being made of individual features and groups as appropriate. The photographic record will consist of high-quality digital uninterpolated images of at least 10 megapixels. Digital photographs intended for archive purposes will comply with best

	practice i.e. high quality non-proprietary raw files (DNG) or TIFF images
How Data will be Collected/Created	The data will be created according to MOLA's Fieldwork Manual and MOLA's Data Management Procedure, and in accordance with the county guidelines. • All site data recorded on iPads Pro tablets will be entered into the site's ORACLE CDE database. • Site data will be captured digitally using APEX pro-forma digital context sheets based on the MOLA Fieldwork Recording Manual. The creation of physical records is not required. • Drawings, plans and sections will be captured digitally using Arrette Sketch app, to be imported into APEX context sheets. These will be created to scale, to standards set out in Data Management Procedure. • Images will be taken using a combination of cameras with an APS-C or larger sensor, supported by images captured using the on-site iPad Pro tablets, making use of the in-built 12 megapixel camera, to be imported into APEX context sheets, and DSLRs taking high quality non-proprietary raw files (DNG) • Survey data will be recorded accurately using Leica Viva Survey Grade RTK GNSS using SMARTNET real-time corrections, operating to a 3D tolerance of ± 0.05m to Ordnance Survey National Grid and Datum. These data will be stored as DWG or similar file types. • GPS Survey data and on-site drawings will be used to create digital illustrations using AutoCAD, ArcGIS, CorelDraw X7 and/or MapInfo software. • File structure will be created automatically by Union Square Knowledge Management System and ORACLE CDE databasing. Version control will be managed by a strict file-naming structure and by Union Square Knowledge Management System's inbuilt version control manager.
Relations	Usually for archaeological reports this will be N/A
Documentation and Metadata	
Metadata	Metadata will be created to the standard set out in MOLA's Data Management Procedure. Metadata tables will be updated throughout the course of the project and will be archived along with the digital data at the end of the project.
Documentation	The data will be accompanied by the digital site report, databases, survey data and processed illustrations as PDFs. No additional documentation is required
Ethical and Legal Compliance	
Data Security Issues	The dataset may contain commercially sensitive data due to the ongoing work of the Planning application. Additionally, some sites may have sensitivity due to actual/perceived security issues to landowners/tenants. MOLA will not make data available to any persons outside of the approved project team/ registered organisations, without discussion and approval of Orion

	heritage and Taylor Wimpey. MOLA will communicate data and updates to Orion Heritage and Taylor Wimpey who will be responsible for distributing any relevant data to any other third parties
Intellectual Property Rights	The copyright of any written, graphic or photographic records and reports will rest with MOLA. The data and reports created by any external specialists will be MOLA Copyright; this will be managed through their contracts. Other data not owned by MOLA, such as OS data, HER datasets or historic maps, will be used under licence and any downloaded data will be deleted from MOLA systems at the end of the term of the licence agreement. Taylor Wimpey shall have an irrevocable, royalty free licence to copy and use the results of the works and to reproduce the designs contained in them for any purpose related to the project, without limitation. Once the results of the work are deemed to have entered the public domain, Wiltshire Council will have permission to use the report for the purposes of the Historic Environment Record which may include circulating the report to third parties.
Data Storage	
Storage and Backup	• All digital data collected on site will be backed up to the cloud every 15 minutes in the presence of a signal or cached and backed up as and when a signal is present. • Quality assurance processes will include regular review of the collected data on site. Records will be checked in the office by Team Leaders . • MOLA will retain a back-up of the digital data of the project for a minimum of five years following the deposition of the site archive, in accordance with MOLA's Digital Management Procedure.
Access and Security	• Data recording platforms used on site, i.e. iPad Pro tablets and laptops, will be password protected to prevent unauthorised access. • Data will be made available to the project team/ external specialists through the ORACLE CDE cloud-based system controlled via password access, maintained and managed by MOLA IT support.
Selection and Preservation	
Preservation Plan	• The physical and digital archives will be constructed in accordance with local and national guidelines, and specifically with reference to MOLA's Physical and Digital Data Retention/Discard policies. Discarded data that has been identified for deletion will be recorded as such within the metadata and site records, as appropriate. • The physical site archive for this phase of works will be temporarily stored at the MOLA office on the front cover of this document. The physical archive accession code is TBC and upon completion of full analysis, the physical project archive

	and hard copy of the reports will be deposited at the Swindon Museum and Art Gallery. • The digital site archive comprising the report, ORACLE database, digital photographs, survey data and metadata tables will be archived with the ADS. • Further archiving decisions will be made in discussion with the Archaeological Advisor at Wiltshire Council (CCCSA) and ADS at project completion stage
Data Sharing	
Data Sharing Plan	• Information regarding current excavation data and site progress will be provided on a weekly basis to Taylor Wimpey and Orion Heritage in a suitable digital format. The project ArchGIS will be provided to Taylor Wimpey Orion Heritage and the Archaeological Advisor. • During the course of the project, site data will need to be shared with external persons for the acquisition of specialist reporting. External specialists will be given access to ORACLE CDE, MOLA's cloud-based databasing system. The data will not be shared more widely at this stage. • The data generated from this project will be made publicly available through submission to the Archaeological Data Service (ADS) as a digital archive and the finished report will be submitted to the Online AccesS to the Index of archaeological investigationS (OASIS). • The file types submitted will comply with ADS digital archiving guidance in order to ensure maximum compatibility and access
Data Sharing Restrictions	There are no known restrictions on the use of this data after project completion although data will be kept confidential during the course of the project.
Responsibilities and Resources	
Responsibilities	A dedicated Digital Data Officer, with the Project Manager and the Senior Archaeological Archivist are responsible for ensuring the data management plan is followed.
Resources	• Due to the fully digital nature of the site archive, guidance on born-digital data will be given throughout the project by John Layt (Digital data manager) and James Ladocha (Geomatics Manager), supported by MOLA IT staff. Additional resources include recording platforms (iPad Pro) and applications APEX and Arrette Sketch which will be provided and maintained by MOLA • Requirements for training in digital data collection techniques will be managed by MOLA. • The costs of deposition of the digital archive will be covered within the project budget.
References	Swindon Borough Council 2022 Guidelines and Conditions for the Preparation and Deposition of Archaeological Archives